



BOULDER VALLEY
SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education | March 14, 2023

Long Range Advisory Committee

LRAC Purpose

To develop recommendations to ensure sound long-term facility decisions consistent with the needs of the school district and in support of the school district's strategic initiatives

What LRAC IS

- An opportunity to develop metrics and guiding principles for the board to use in future decision making related to addressing how declining enrollment impacts student & staff experiences and district finances

What LRAC is NOT

- A committee to solve declining enrollment
- A committee to solve affordable housing
- A committee to generate marketing ideas
- A committee to address declining birth rates



Process Overview

Phase 1: Getting grounded in current state with data review and discussions

Phase 2: Producing Recommendations

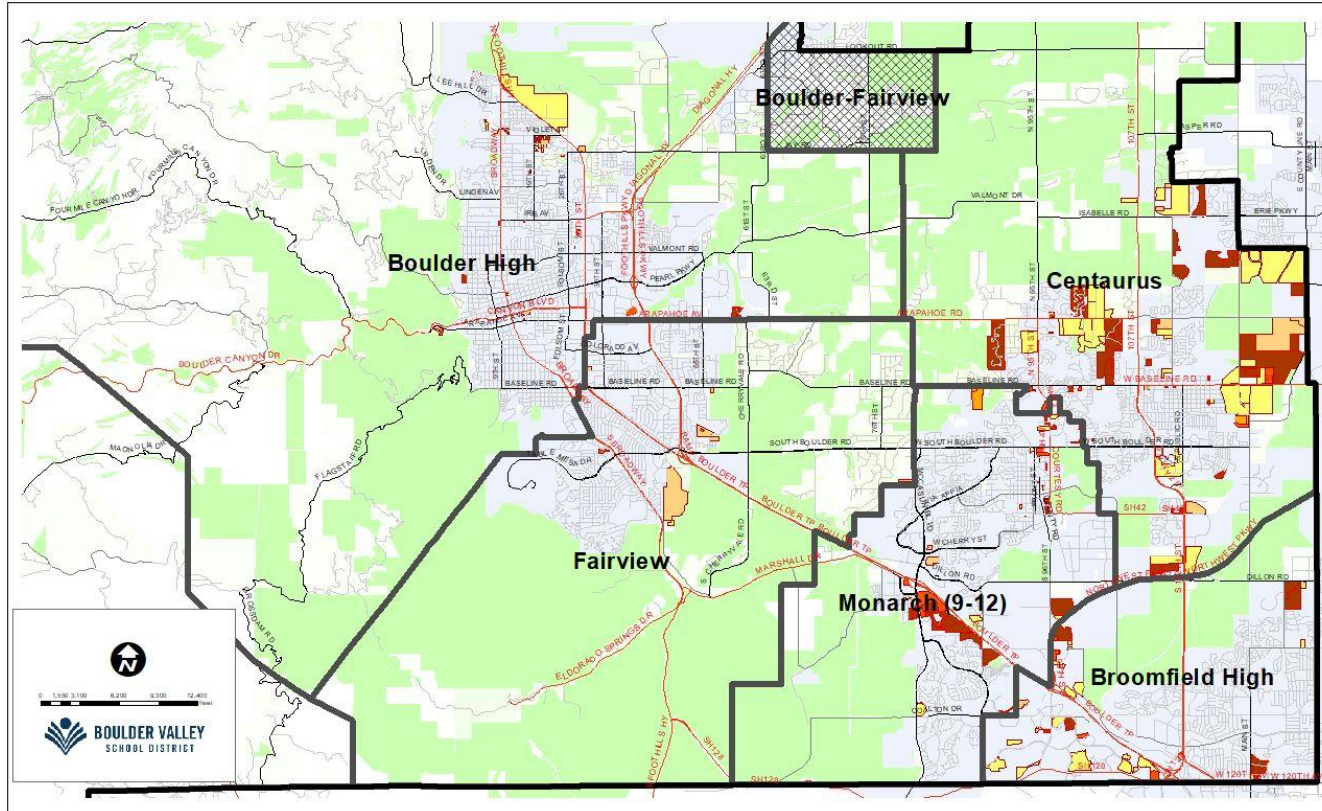




LRAC UPDATE

Data Highlights

Location of Potential New Housing



All BVSD

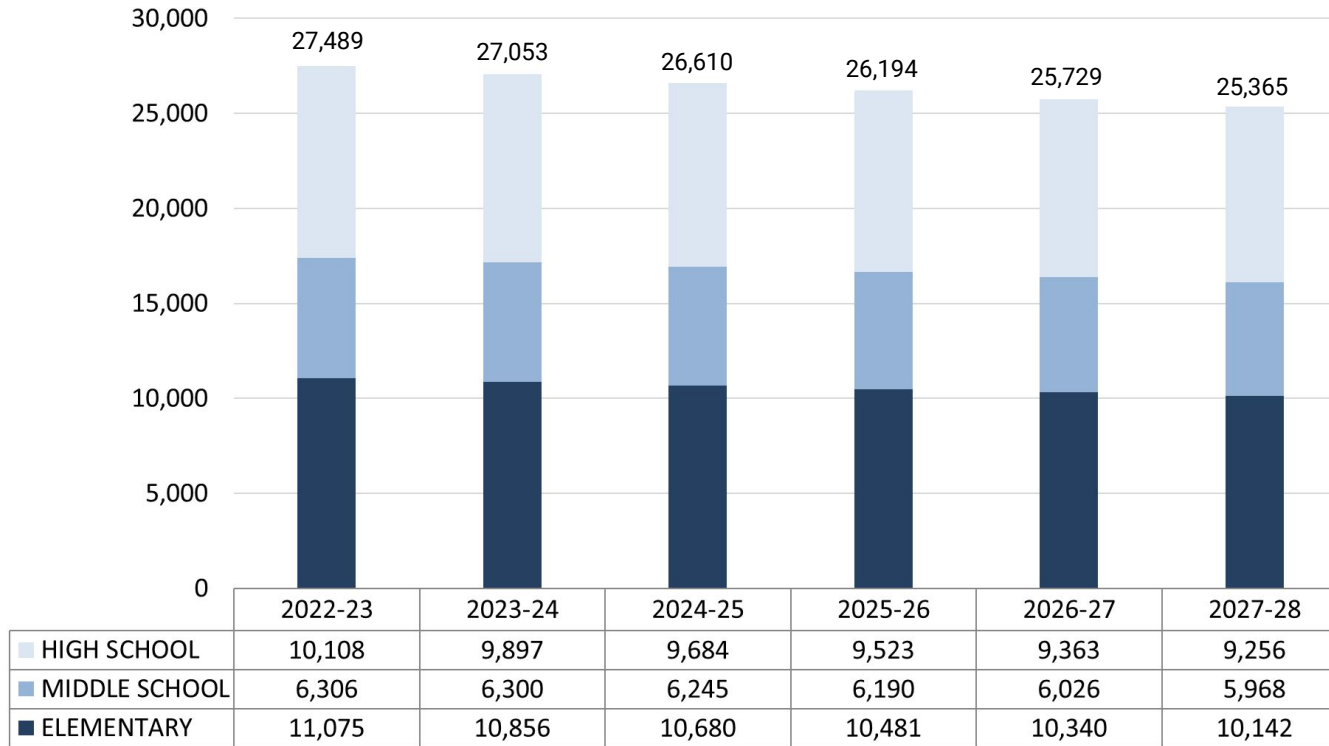
El. = 2,824

M.S.= 1,172

H.S.= 1,653



5-year K-12* Enrollment Projections



**Preschool not included due to the difficulty to assess demand and due to it's disconnect with school attendance areas.*



Preliminary Trend by Classes/Grade (rounds)

Elementary Level (excluding mountain schools)

The number of students at each grade in a school along with the staffing ratio for the grade determines how many classes there will be at a particular grade level. This is often referred to as the number of rounds (classes/grade).

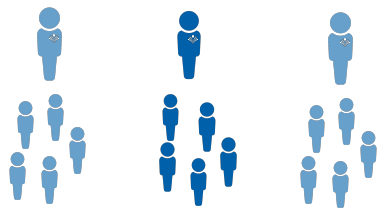
	2022-23	2025-26	2027-28
< 2.0 rounds	5 schools	10 schools	12 schools
< 1.5 rounds	1 school	3 schools	3 schools

Elementary School Programmatic Impacts

Three Round

(3 classes per grade level)

Grade 1

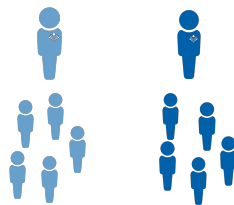


- ABC Specials rotation
- Instrumental music
- Ideal for programming

Two Round

(2 classes per grade level)

Grade 1



- Traveling teachers
- Scheduling complexity & limitations
- Programming limitations

One Round

(1 class per grade level)

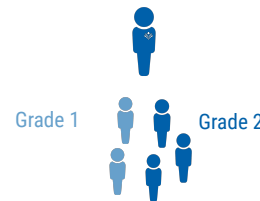
Grade 1



- Limited teacher collaboration
- Lack of flexibility to shift students
- More programming limitations

Multi Grade

(<1 class per grade level)



- Yearly change
- Complex planning for teachers

Financial Impacts

- As enrollment declines at a school, fixed costs are distributed over fewer students, increasing the cost per student.
- Instructional resources may also ratchet down, corresponding to lower enrollment.
- Disproportionate resources are required to maintain smaller schools, diverting funding from other student and district needs.
- As the number of smaller schools increases, the proportion of the general fund allocated to subsidize those schools grows.
- **The school district's budget is about trade-offs; money spent in one area cannot be spent elsewhere.**

Metrics and Recommendations

- Reviewed metrics used by other districts to help inform the work
- Staff proposed metrics and recommendations for committee discussion.
- Metrics aim to identify when the district should consider taking action; determined by enrollment and utilization data.
- Recommendations aim to describe what actions the district might take
- Staff also suggested an annual report to the Board on enrollment projections and utilization.





Upcoming Meetings

- Mar. 14 | Board update
- Mar. 20 | Committee meeting
- Apr. 17 | Committee meeting (if needed)
- **May 16 | Board worksession**
- Jun. 13 | LRAC recommendations presented to Board

